

# Free Cars & Transportation Help

Need a vehicle or a way to get to work, school, or medical care? Charities donate cars to families in need, and other programs help with rides and fares. Below are the main national starting points. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

## ⚠ BEFORE YOU START

There are real charities that give away donated cars — but demand is high and applying is always free. Be patient and apply to several. Any program charging an application fee is a scam.

## 1 Charities That Donate Cars

These national nonprofits refurbish donated vehicles and give them to qualifying families, often for work or medical need.

### ☐ Free Charity Cars / 1-800-Charity Cars

The nation's oldest and largest car-donation charity. Apply online; priority for survivors, veterans, and families with urgent need.

→ [www.800charitycars.org](http://www.800charitycars.org)

### ☐ Working Cars for Working Families (NCLC)

A national directory of car-ownership programs — the best tool to find a local group that gives or finances cars near you.

→ [www.workingcarsforworkingfamilies.org](http://www.workingcarsforworkingfamilies.org)

### ☐ Vehicles for Change

Provides low-cost cars to working families in the areas it serves, and runs auto-training programs.

→ [www.vehiclesforchange.org](http://www.vehiclesforchange.org)

## 2 Help Through Local Programs

State and local programs sometimes provide cars or transportation help tied to work or job training.

### ☐ TANF — Work-Related Transportation

If you get TANF (cash assistance), your state may help with a car, repairs, or transport to work. Ask your caseworker.

→ [www.acf.hhs.gov/ofa/programs/tanf/about](http://www.acf.hhs.gov/ofa/programs/tanf/about)

### ☐ 211 — Local Vehicle & Ride Help

Call or search for local car-donation programs, gas cards, and transportation help.

→ [www.211.org](http://www.211.org) or dial 211

### 3 Get to Medical Care

If your need is getting to doctor visits, there's free non-emergency medical transportation for many people.

#### ☐ Medicaid Non-Emergency Medical Transportation

If you have Medicaid, you may get free rides to medical appointments. Ask your state Medicaid office or plan.

→ [www.medicaid.gov/medicaid/benefits/non-emergency-medical-transportation](http://www.medicaid.gov/medicaid/benefits/non-emergency-medical-transportation)

#### ☐ Eldercare Locator — Senior Rides

Connects older adults to local transportation services and ride programs.

→ [eldercare.acl.gov](http://eldercare.acl.gov) or call 1-800-677-1110

### 4 Everyday Ride Help

For getting to work or job interviews while you wait for a car.

#### ☐ Local Public Transit Reduced Fares

Most transit agencies offer reduced fares for seniors, people with disabilities, and low-income riders. Ask your local transit office.

→ Ask your local transit agency

#### ☐ United Way / Ride United

In many areas, United Way partners on rides to work, interviews, and appointments. Ask 211.

→ [www.211.org](http://www.211.org) or dial 211

#### ⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

If a "free car" offer asks for a fee, gift card, or your bank login to "release" the vehicle, it's a scam. Real charities never charge to apply and never ask for payment to hand over a car.

#### ★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Apply to more than one car charity and keep your application updated — waitlists are long and need is weighed heavily. A short letter explaining how a car gets you to work can make your case stronger.

#### NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

#### Ask for your personalized transportation search

This guide covers the main national programs. For car-donation programs and ride help specific to your city or county, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we'll help you find the closest options.

#### MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID

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